

CHAPTER 2

Nelson Mandela: Long Walk to Freedom

NCERT Exercise Solutions

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✨ Try each question yourself first, then check the answer. 💡 answers are samples: write your own.

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⭐ Let's Begin

1 **Mandela draws our attention to the meaning and importance of freedom and leading a life with freedom. He states that freedom comes with responsibilities. Discuss with your peers, how freedom and responsibilities go hand in hand.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Freedom and responsibility go together like two sides of a coin.

- Freedom gives us rights, but we must not use them to harm others. As Mandela says, to be free is to live in a way that **respects and enhances the freedom of others**.
- A free citizen must obey laws, pay taxes, vote wisely and protect public property.
- Mandela felt he had duties to his family, his people and his country; his freedom was bound up with theirs.
- Freedom without responsibility becomes misuse; responsibility makes freedom last.

So, the more freedom we enjoy, the greater our duty to protect it for everyone.

⭐ Reading Comprehension · Text I

Q.1 **The occasion of the speech of Sardar Patel here is _____.**

(a) an address to a public gathering
(b) a convocation address at a university
(c) a speech in Indian Parliament
(d) a speech delivered to civil servants

✔ ANSWER

(b) a convocation address at a university

He thanks the university for conferring an honour and speaks of the 'alma mater' and universities training young men.

Q.2 **Patel feels that future generations will heap curses on us if _____.**

(a) we fail to protect our freedom
(b) we fail to protect the corrupt people in public life
(c) we wage war against other nations
(d) we understand the need for peace

✔ ANSWER

(a) we fail to protect our freedom

He says if we fail to make the best use of our freedom and lose it, 'future generations will heap curses on us'.

Q.3 **The first and foremost thing Patel stressed to be done is _____.**

(a) to make the country strong and united
(b) to give employment to everyone

(c) to fight a war against those who oppressed us

(d) to make every citizen feel happy

✔ ANSWER

(a) to make the country strong and united

'We must concentrate on one thing alone, viz., how to make our country strong and united.'

Q.4 One major characteristic of university education, as Sardar Patel believes, is _____.

(a) character

(b) duty

(c) knowledge

(d) power

✔ ANSWER

(a) character

'The most essential requisite is character.'

Q.5 What did Patel not mean when he said, "You have to realise that India has to attain its rightful place in the comity of nations"? Tick the right answer.

(a) Friendly and cordial relationship with other nations

(b) Group of nations which wage war against other

(c) Community of people

(d) Nations from a continent

✔ ANSWER

(b) Group of nations which wage war against other

'Comity of nations' means friendly respect and cooperation among nations, not nations at war.

Q.6 **'India abounds in the resources of nature and manpower' means _____.**

(a) India has a vibrant economy

(b) India's natural resources and population are a great resource

(c) India's lack of manpower

(d) Indians are great resource for development

✔ ANSWER

(b) India's natural resources and population are a great resource

'Abounds' means has plenty of; Patel says these resources 'are awaiting full use'.

Q.7 **What is the greatest danger for India as Patel believes in his speech?**

(a) India has a vibrant economy.

(b) India's natural resources and population are a great resource.

(c) India's lack of manpower.

(d) Indians are great resource for development.

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

None of the printed options fits (they repeat the options of Q.6).

Answer from the text: the greatest danger is **disunity** — 'The real danger of India lies in our disunity', including the poison of communalism.

Q.8 **Complete the following statement based on your understanding of Patel's speech. The first and foremost duty of the young nation is _____**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

The first and foremost duty of the young nation is **to make the country strong and united** by consolidating the hard-won freedom. Citizens, especially the youth, must build character, stay disciplined, give up disunity and communalism, help one another and work with single-minded devotion for the nation.

⭐ Vocabulary

1 **Use the following words and phrases in your own sentences.**

(a) Precincts

(b) Comity of nations

(c) Unassailable

(d) Mutual cooperation

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

(a) **Precincts:** Students are not allowed to use mobile phones within the precincts of the school.

(b) **Comity of nations:** India is respected in the comity of nations for its peaceful policies.

(c) **Unassailable:** With five goals in the first half, our team built an unassailable lead.

(d) **Mutual cooperation:** The two villages rebuilt the bridge through mutual cooperation.

2 **Sardar Patel called upon young students to understand the meaning of freedom and ways to sustain it. Here are two key words which he stressed upon—'Freedom' and 'Responsibility'. Working in pairs, find words and phrases which convey the feeling of these words and write below.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Freedom	Responsibility
liberty	duty
independence	obligation
hard-won	burden
sacrifice	discipline
self-rule	citizenship
rights	character
choice	mutual cooperation

dignity	devotion to the country

2 (sentences) **Using the words write at least five sentences describing 'Freedom' and 'Responsibility'. Example: Freedom is not free.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

- Freedom is not free; it was won through great sacrifice.
- Liberty brings with it the duty to respect the rights of others.
- Our hard-won independence must be protected with discipline.
- Every citizen has an obligation to keep the nation united.
- Freedom gives us choices, and responsibility helps us choose wisely.
- Good character and devotion to the country make freedom last.

⭐ Grammar · Use of Articles

1 **Fill in the blanks with articles:**

____ weapons of ____ world war were: violence, brute force, political and military moves, and counter moves. As ____ result of ____ churning of the ocean, ____ world has emitted poison. That poison is spreading all over and there is none to swallow it. ____

countries which were free have managed to digest it somewhat, but we, who have just attained our freedom, it is hard to do ____ same. Therefore, those who think that having attained freedom they have attained everything, have really attained nothing! ____ freedom that we have won is yet to be consolidated.

✔ ANSWER

The weapons of **the** World War were: violence, brute force, political and military moves, and counter moves. As **a** result of **the** churning of the ocean, **the** world has emitted poison. ... **The** countries which were free have managed to digest it somewhat, but ... it is hard to do **the** same. ... **The** freedom that we have won is yet to be consolidated.

Answers in order: The, the, a, the, the, The, the, The.

2 **Which article most frequently occurs in the passage? Why is it so? Can you replace it with some other article? Why / Why not? Discuss with your peers and make notes.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

- **'The'** occurs most often (7 of the 8 blanks).

- It is the definite article, used for **particular, known things**: the World War (a specific war), the world (only one), the same, the countries which were free, the freedom that we have won (made specific by a clause).
- It **cannot be replaced** by 'a' or 'an', because these are used for any one, non-specific, singular countable noun. Here the nouns are specific, unique or plural (weapons, countries), so 'a/an' would be wrong.
- Only 'as **a** result of' takes 'a', because it is a fixed phrase.

3 **Fill in the blanks with suitable articles.**

(a) ____ boy and ____ girl were shopping in a market. ____ boy was from Kerala and ____ girl was from Nagaland.

(b) Can you turn off ____ light?

(c) He has taken ____ taxi to ____ station.

(d) Is there ____ police station nearby?

(e) My sister works in ____ bank.

(f) He has been looking for ____ job for the last seven years.

(g) Would you like to eat ____ apple?

(h) He goes to the theatre once ____ month.

(i) This morning I bought ____ newspaper and ____ magazine. ____ newspaper is on my table and I forgot where I have placed ____ magazine.

(j) We would like to have dinner at ____ good restaurant.

✔ ANSWER

(a) **A** boy and **a** girl ... **The** boy ... **the** girl

(b) **the** light

(c) **a** taxi to **the** station

(d) **a** police station

(e) **a** bank

(f) **a** job

(g) **an** apple

(h) once **a** month

(i) **a** newspaper and **a** magazine. **The** newspaper ... **the** magazine

(j) **a** good restaurant

Rule: 'a/an' when a thing is mentioned first or is any one; 'the' when it is already known or specific.

⭐ Editing

1 **The following passage has an error in each line. Find the error and write the correct word or words against the line.**

I don't mean that some peoples are born clear headed

and is therefore natural writers, whereas others

are naturally fuzzy and will never wrote well.

Thinking clearly was a conscious act that writers
must forced on themselves, as if they were working
on any other project that requires logic: makes
shopping list or doing an algebra problems.
Good writing do not come naturally,
though most people seems to think it does.
Professional writer are constantly bearded by
people who say they'd like to "trying a little
writing sometime" — meaned when they
retire from their real profession.

✔ ANSWER

Line	Error	Correction
1	peoples	people
2	is	are
3	wrote	write
4	was	is
5	forced	force
6	makes	making
7	problems	problem
8	do	does
9	seems	seem
10	writer	writers
11	trying	try
12	meaned	meaning

13	their	a

⭐ Listening

1 **Your teacher or any one student will read out the text given below to the whole class. Listen carefully. Working in groups of four, note down in short the important points as you listen. Discuss in your group. Recreate and write the text you have listened to. (Text for listening: "A few minutes ago, walking back from lunch, I started to cross the street when I heard the sound of a coin dropping...")**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Notes:

- walking back from lunch, crossing street
- heard a coin drop; many people turned their heads
- woman dropped a one-rupee coin
- tinkling sound on pavement grabs attention
- value does not matter; no one can ignore the sound
- made the writer think about sounds

Recreated text: A little while ago, as I was coming back from lunch and crossing the road, I heard a coin fall. It was a small sound, but when I turned, I saw that several other people had turned their heads too. A woman had dropped what looked like a one-rupee coin. The tinkle of a coin falling on the pavement always catches our attention. Whatever the coin's value, nobody can ignore that sound. It made me think about sounds once again.

⭐ Speaking

1 **You have read the speeches of Nelson Mandela and Sardar Patel. You know their beliefs and ideas on freedom and responsibilities for a new born nation. Discuss with your partner and put down your ideas on what freedom means to you. Prepare an outline.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Outline: What freedom means to me

- Introduction: freedom was won through the sacrifices of leaders like Mandela, Gandhi and Patel.
- Freedom to think, speak, study and choose my career.
- Freedom from fear, hunger, discrimination and injustice (Mandela: freedom for all, not just for me).

- Freedom is not doing whatever I like; it must respect others' freedom.
- Duties: follow laws, keep the country united, protect public property, vote.
- Conclusion: 'Freedom is not free' — we must deserve and protect it.

2 **Prepare a speech for the morning assembly reflecting on the following questions.**

(a) How do you feel today about the country's freedom?

(b) Are we free and independent?

(c) Are we serious about our responsibilities as citizens?

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

Good morning, respected Principal, teachers and my dear friends.

Today I wish to share a few thoughts on our country's freedom.

I feel proud that we live in a free country. Our freedom was won after a long and bitter struggle, through the sacrifices of thousands of freedom fighters. Today we can study, speak and choose our way of life freely.

But are we truly free? Politically we are independent. Yet many people are still not free from poverty, illiteracy, caste and gender discrimination. As Nelson Mandela said, no one is truly free while others are not.

Are we serious about our duties? Often we are not. We litter streets, waste water, break traffic rules and forget our duties while demanding our rights. Sardar Patel reminded us that freedom must be consolidated through character, discipline and unity.

Let us promise today to be honest, disciplined and united, and to respect the rights of others. Only then will we truly deserve our freedom.

Thank you. Jai Hind!

⭐ Writing

1 **Make pairs. One of you takes the role of Nelson Mandela and the other becomes the interviewer.**

(a) The interviewer prepares a questionnaire on Nelson Mandela—Mandela as a person and his contributions to the removal of Apartheid.

(b) The interviewee responds to them. The interviewer's task is to note down the answers also.

(c) The interviewer, through the questions, tries to get an overview of Mandela's life.

(Tables: For interviewer – Questions to be framed 1–5; For interviewee – Answers 1–5)

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

S. No.	Question (interviewer)	Answer (Mandela)

1	What was your childhood like?	I was born in a village in the Transkei. As a boy I felt free — free to run in the fields and swim in the streams.
2	When did you realise you were not free?	As a young man I learnt that my boyhood freedom was an illusion. As a black man I was not free, and neither were my people.
3	What made you join the struggle against apartheid?	The hunger for the freedom of my people, not just my own, turned me from a frightened young man into a bold one. I joined the African National Congress.
4	What did the struggle cost you?	I spent about thirty years in prison and could not fulfil my duties as a son, husband and father. Many of my comrades suffered greatly.
5	What was your proudest moment?	On 10 May 1994 I took the oath as the first Black President of a democratic, non-racial South Africa. I believe the oppressor and the oppressed must both be liberated.

2 **Make groups of four and find out the background information on Nelson Mandela, Mahatma Gandhi, and Martin Luther King. All three of them fought against all odds and used non-violence to achieve their aim.**

Choose any two of the above stated leaders and do a comparative study of their principles and lives. (Table: S. No. 1–10, Leader 1, Leader 2)

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

S. No.	Leader 1: Mahatma Gandhi	Leader 2: Nelson Mandela
1	Born 2 October 1869, Porbandar, India	Born 18 July 1918, Mvezo, South Africa
2	Studied law in London	Studied law in South Africa
3	Fought racial discrimination in South Africa, then British rule in India	Fought apartheid (racial segregation) in South Africa
4	Principles: truth (satya) and non-violence (ahimsa)	Began with non-violence; later supported armed resistance when peaceful protest was crushed
5	Led the Non-Cooperation, Salt (Dandi) March and Quit India movements	Led the ANC's Defiance Campaign; worked with the ANC
6	Jailed many times by the British	Jailed for about 27 years (Robben Island)
7	Simple life, spinning khadi, fasting as protest	Patience, forgiveness and reconciliation after release

8	Helped India win independence in 1947	Became South Africa's first Black President in 1994
9	Called 'Father of the Nation'; assassinated in 1948	Nobel Peace Prize 1993; died 5 December 2013
10	Inspired Mandela and Martin Luther King	Inspired by Gandhi; a world symbol of freedom and equality

🛠️ Project

1 You have learnt about the freedom struggles of many nations after the Second World War and how many leaders spearheaded freedom movements in their countries. Based on the learning from history and political science, write about any two leaders from different nations. The following are prompts that can help you:

(a) Their thoughts

(b) Their uniqueness

(c) Honesty and integrity

(d) Confidence and leadership qualities

(e) Inspirational speeches

(f) Contributions to free their countries

(Hints: You may develop their profiles in chronological order. You may visit the library. Consult social science teachers in your school and elders in your neighbourhood.)

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

1. Ho Chi Minh (Vietnam, 1890–1969)

- **Thoughts:** believed 'nothing is more precious than independence and freedom'; wanted a Vietnam free of colonial rule.
- **Uniqueness:** worked abroad as a cook and labourer, studied world politics, and founded the Indochinese Communist Party (1930).
- **Honesty and integrity:** lived very simply, even as President.

- **Leadership:** united peasants and workers in the Viet Minh and led the struggle against France.
- **Inspirational speech:** Declaration of Independence of Vietnam, 2 September 1945, Hanoi.
- **Contribution:** led Vietnam to freedom from French rule (1954) and inspired its later reunification.

2. **Kwame Nkrumah (Ghana, 1909–1972)**

- **Thoughts:** Pan-Africanism; 'We face neither East nor West; we face forward.'
- **Uniqueness:** studied in the USA and UK; led one of the first African colonies to independence.
- **Honesty and integrity:** stood firm for self-rule even when jailed by the British.
- **Leadership:** founded the Convention People's Party (1949); led strikes and 'Positive Action' through non-violent protest.
- **Inspirational speech:** Independence speech, 6 March 1957: 'Ghana, our beloved country, is free for ever!'
- **Contribution:** won Ghana's freedom from Britain in 1957 and became its first Prime Minister, inspiring other African nations.

(You may choose other leaders, e.g. Sukarno of Indonesia or Jomo Kenyatta of Kenya.)

🎉 **Chapter 2 done! Revise the answers once more tomorrow.**